

Open Resource Release Plan

Releasing the biophoton field map as an open, living community resource.

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DISTRIBUTION	OSF Foundation Council
REFERENCE	RPT-2026-BPH-006 · PRJ-BIOPHOTON
DECISIONS	CC0 license. Inverted-index abstracts. Living, refreshed resource.

• Purpose

This plan sets out how to release the biophoton and ultra-weak photon emission (UPE) field map as an open, living community resource. The field map already covers 18,355 works and 39,312 authors, is reproducible from a cached pipeline, and ships interactive tools as self-contained HTML. The remaining work is packaging, privacy, licensing, hosting, and governance, not new analysis.

• Decisions locked

- **License: CC0.** The derived bibliometric metadata is released into the public domain, matching the CC0 license of the underlying OpenAlex data. A citation request accompanies the release, but reuse carries no legal conditions.
- **Abstracts: inverted index.** Abstracts are distributed in the OpenAlex inverted-index form rather than as reconstructed prose. This mirrors OpenAlex and removes the copyright question. The tools reconstruct abstracts locally for search and display, so functionality is preserved.
- **Maintenance: living resource.** The resource is published as versioned releases on a recurring refresh, with a corrections channel and a named maintainer, rather than as a single frozen snapshot.

• What is released, and what is held back

Everything is public except the contact-email data, which stays internal to OSF under the legitimate-interest basis recorded in the data ethics note.

Released openly:

- The field database (SQLite, plus parquet and CSV of every table).
- The full ranked paper index with a full-text search index.
- The researcher table with the email column removed, keeping only public identifiers (ORCID and ROR institution).
- The four network graphs for Gephi.
- The interactive field map and paper search pages.
- The state-of-field report, the OSF PDFs, and the methods documentation.
- The pipeline source code.

Held back, internal to OSF:

- The corresponding-author email column and the PDF fetch log.
- Downloaded open-access PDFs, since redistribution rights vary by publisher.
- The OpenAlex API key.

A release script enforces the split. The public bundle is produced by code, not by hand, so no email can leak by accident.

• Attribution

CC0 requests, but does not require, citation. The release credits OpenAlex for the source data, ORCID and ROR for identifiers, and Michal Cifra's seed library for the field anchor. A CITATION.cff file and a concept DOI make the resource citable in one line.

• Packaging

The release ships in three layers so different users are served.

- **Archival data package.** SQLite, parquet, CSV, and GraphML, with a data dictionary documenting every table and column, and a machine-readable datapackage descriptor for discovery.
- **Interactive layer.** The field-map report and the paper-search page, already self-contained static HTML.
- **Reproducibility layer.** The pinned pipeline, a pinned requirements file, the OpenAlex snapshot date, and the citation metadata.

• Hosting and distribution

All components are free and standard for open science.

- **Zenodo** mints a DOI for each versioned release. This is the citable, permanent anchor.
- **GitHub** holds the pipeline code and the issue tracker, which doubles as the corrections channel, and serves the interactive HTML through GitHub Pages at no cost, since the tools are already static.
- **The OSF project page** provides the branded institutional home, aligned with the Foundation mission.
- Registration with a research-data registry adds discoverability.

• Reproducibility and the refresh cycle

The on-disk cache makes any run byte-reproducible from the pinned snapshot date. Releases follow semantic versions under a single concept DOI, with a changelog. The pipeline re-runs cheaply, on the order of two thousand OpenAlex calls on a free key, so a biannual refresh keeps the resource current. Each refresh is a new versioned release produced by the same scripted path: harvest, strip the private columns, package, publish.

• Governance and community contribution

Governance is what turns a data package into a resource.

- **Steward.** OSF and OSI provide the institutional home. A named maintainer owns the refresh and the issue queue.
- **Corrections.** A public channel handles the two known weak spots: author disambiguation errors of the Van Wijk and Popp kind, and missing grey literature such as the eighteen unmatched seeds, patents, and theses. Contributions from the field are realistic and improve quality.
- **Opt-out.** A documented route lets any researcher have their row amended or removed, honoring the ethics basis.
- **Advisory input.** The openness overlay already identifies who builds in the open. Those researchers are the natural first reviewers and endorsers.

• Launch and outreach

A short data descriptor, most of which already exists in the state-of-field report, is posted as a preprint. Posting a preprint is itself an open-science act consistent with the book thesis. The mapped community is reached through the public routing already built, and at the venues the map identifies. The book becomes both a product of the resource and its advertisement.

• Roadmap

1. **Release preparation.** Write the release and privacy-strip script, the data dictionary, the citation metadata, the data package descriptor, and the license files. Convert abstracts to inverted-index form for the public bundle. 2. **Publish version one.** Zenodo DOI, GitHub repository, GitHub Pages for the interactive tools, and the OSF project page. 3. **Governance live.** Corrections and opt-out channels open, maintainer named. 4. **Announce.** Preprint and outreach to the field. 5. **Sustain.** Scheduled refresh and versioned re-releases.

• Immediate next steps

- Produce the public release bundle locally, so it is ready to upload. This is code we can write now: strip the email column, convert abstracts to inverted index, add the license, data dictionary, citation file, and package descriptor.
- Name a maintainer and create the OSF project shell.
- Reserve the Zenodo concept DOI and the GitHub repository.